

STREAMA

SHIFT TO DIGITAL WELLBEING

THE
PRODUCT
F🚀LKS

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Problem Statement

Streaming platforms like Streama have historically optimized for engagement metrics such as watch time and session length. While this has driven short-term growth, emerging behavioral patterns indicate that **prolonged binge consumption of emotionally intense content** is leading to mental fatigue, reduced session satisfaction, and long-term trust erosion among highly engaged users.



Observed User Behavior

- Long, uninterrupted late-night sessions
- Repeated consumption of emotionally heavy genres
- Loss of time awareness due to autoplay
- Post-session guilt and fatigue



Business Signals

- Engagement metrics remain strong in the short term
- Retention weakens over longer horizons
- Churn is silent, not complaint-driven
- Brand relationship weakens before cancellation



Key Observations

- Users subscribe to a platform for the content not for the brand of the platform
- But when users churn due to binge fatigue, less content or high price, they leave with a negative image of the brand of the platform

Why should Streama prioritize digital wellbeing now?

Streama should not position digital wellbeing as a brand promise, but as an invisible experience upgrade. Users choose platforms for content, but they quit platforms that leave them feeling guilty after each session. By quietly redesigning for healthier viewing rhythms, Streama reduces fatigue-driven churn among its most engaged users, increases long-term retention, and **compounds lifetime value without compromising engagement.**

Potential User Personas with habit of bingeing

Casual Comfort Viewers

Behavior Patterns

- Watches in short, intentional sessions
- Often multitasks while watching
- Rarely binge watches full seasons

Beliefs

- TV is relaxation, not immersion
- Entertainment should feel light and easy

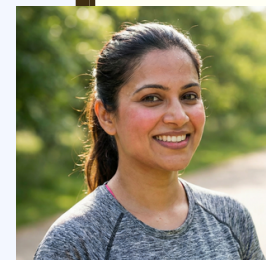
Likes & Preferences

- Sitcoms, light drama, reality shows
- Familiar, rewatchable content
- Clear stopping points

High-Level Demographics

- Age: 30–55
- Mixed family and solo households
- Time-constrained lifestyles

“I just want something easy while I unwind.”



Emotionally Invested Binge Viewers

Behavior Patterns

- Watches late at night after work/study
- Starts with intention to end briefly, ends up bingeing
- Consumes emotionally intense content

Beliefs

- Entertainment is for emotional release
- Balance is important but hard to maintain

Likes & Preferences

- Dark dramas, thrillers, character-driven shows
- Seamless viewing with minimal effort

High-Level Demographics

- Age: 22–38
- Urban professionals and students
- Lives alone or with roommates

“I’ll stop after this episode... I didn’t realize how late it got.”



Intentional Weekend Bingers

Behavior Patterns

- Plans binge sessions deliberately
- Watches during weekends or holidays
- Stops watching once time is over

Beliefs

- Bingeing is fine when intentional
- Control matters more than duration

Likes & Preferences

- High-quality limited series
- Complete seasons and closure
- Clear episode boundaries

High-Level Demographics

- Age: 25–45
- Professionals with strict schedules
- Higher planning and self-regulation
- Mix of urban and suburban

“I’ve got the evening free, I’ll finish this season tonight.”



Chosen ICP: Emotionally Invested Binge Viewers

Ram, 28 M, Product Designer at a mid-stage startup @ Bengaluru

Rationale for ICP: They are the power users who feel the pain sharply and are prone to quit the platform

Unmet Need: To unwind emotionally after mentally exhausting days without feeling drained, guilty, or unproductive the next morning.

Key Value Needed: Guilt free watch sessions

JTBD FOR ICP

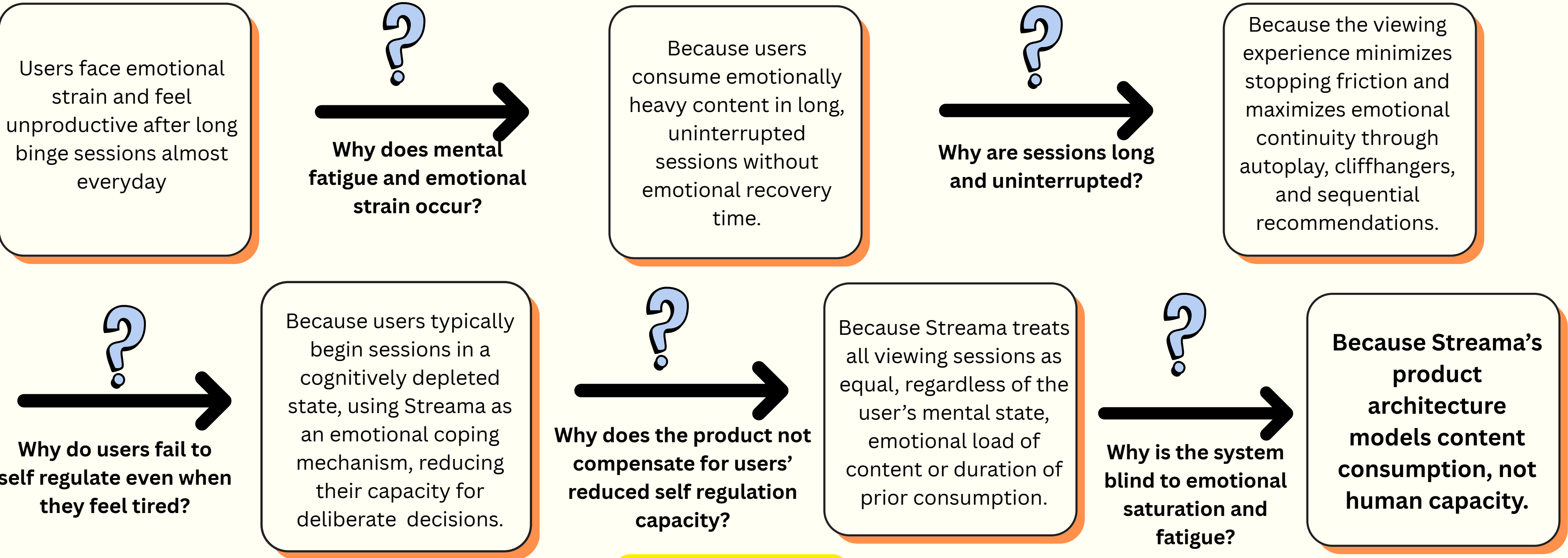
When I finish a long, mentally draining day and finally have time to myself,

I want to watch engaging, immersive content without having to think or decide too much,

So I can mentally disconnect and feel emotionally settled rather than more exhausted.



Finding the True Problem



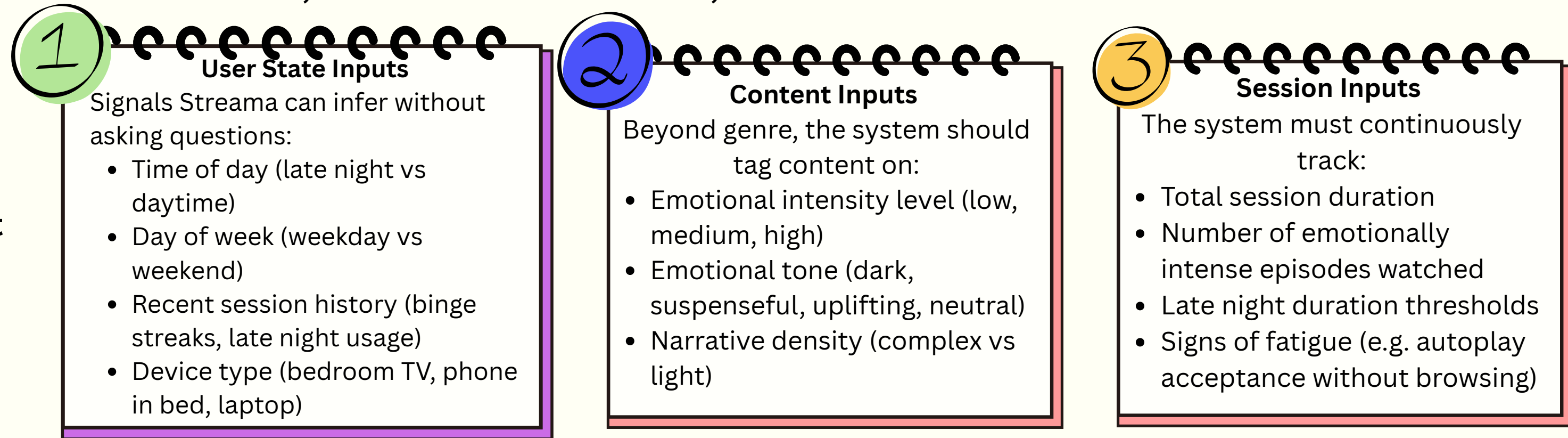
Key Insight

Streama lacks a mental and emotional model of the user and the current content they are consuming, causing it to push continuous engagement even when the user's cognitive capacity to self regulate is already depleted.

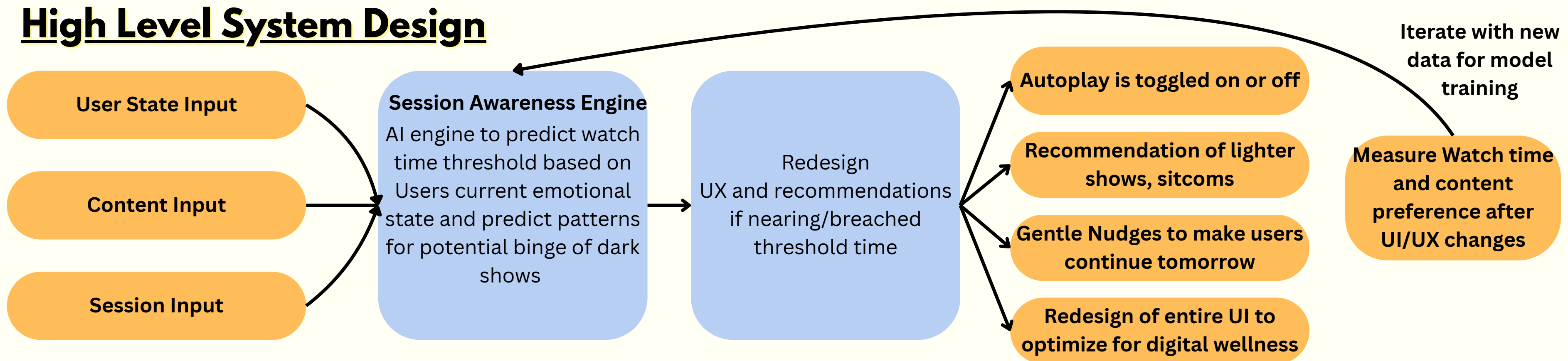
Solution: An Intelligent Session Awareness Engine

Streama should shift from being session agnostic to being session aware, adapting the viewing experience based on user context, emotional load of content, and session duration.

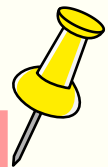
To design for digital wellbeing, the system must factor 3 input dimensions



High Level System Design



Feature List



Feature Name	Description	Notes	Priority
Session Awareness Engine	System layer that infers user emotional capacity using time of day, session duration, recent content intensity, and viewing momentum to calculate a threshold time for binge pattern and dynamically adjust UX behavior across the session.	Model will iteratively learn about user behaviour and modify UI/UX accordng to watch patterns and calcuated threshold	P0
Adaptive Autoplay & Momentum Control	Gradually shifts autoplay behavior from instant continuation to intentional choice as emotional load and session length increase, without hard stops or warnings.	Session length is not hard coded and must be discovered for each user by the Session Awareness Engine.	P0
End-of-Episode Closure UX	Redesigns episode endings with softened transitions, equal-weight continue vs pause choices, and reassurance cues that normalize stopping and provide emotional closure.	Will be toggled on for user if binge patterns are detected for the specific user by Session Awareness Engine	P0
Emotional Pacing Recommendations	Introduces contrast content (lighter, shorter, or stand-alone) when emotional stacking risk is high, preventing fatigue without limiting choice.	Applicatble for people watching potential dark content; Instead of seeing “More like this” section, Users will be nudged to explore lighter genres	P1
Arrival-State UI Modulation	Dynamically adjusts home screen density, visual noise, and content prominence based on predicted emotional state at session start, especially late-night or fatigue contexts.	Risks introducing unfamiliarity with inconsitent UI/UX choices. Must be rolled out in phases with A/B testing	P1

Feature Engineering for Tracking Success

Session Watch Time Threshold (SWTT)	The max time a user can watch a session before entering predicted Binge session. Calculated at the start of a session
Guilt Free Session Definition	No Over-Extension Pattern Session does not cross SWTT.

NSM and Guardrails

Type	Metric	Measured by
North Star Metric for Streama	Guilt-Free Sessions per Active User (Weekly)	# of Guilt Free Sessions/ # of Weekly Active User
Primary Metric for Session Awareness Engine	% of guilt free watch sessions in the platform	# of Guilt Free Sessions / Total Sessions
Guard Rail	Day 30 Retention	# of users active on Day 0 / # of users active on Day 30

Risks and Mitigations

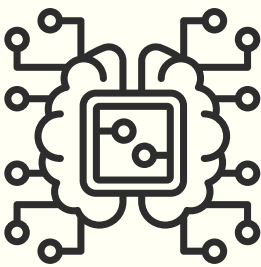
Risks	Mitigations
Incorrect Prediction of Binge patterns leading to frequent interruptions	- Start with high-confidence signals only (session length, late-night usage, emotional intensity stacking) - Apply graduated friction, not binary interruptions - Roll out via small cohort A/B tests with opt-out tracking - Treat false positives as a rollback signal, not a tuning issue
Perceived Loss of Control or “Platform Policing” User Behavior	- Maintain equal-weight choices (Continue vs Pause) - Never block or hard-stop content - Reinforce autonomy through copy like “Continue when you’re ready”
Undermining the Joy of Intentional Bingeing for other viewers	- Intervene only when fatigue or regret signals are detected - Preserve uninterrupted flow for intentional binge sessions

UX Flow of MVP



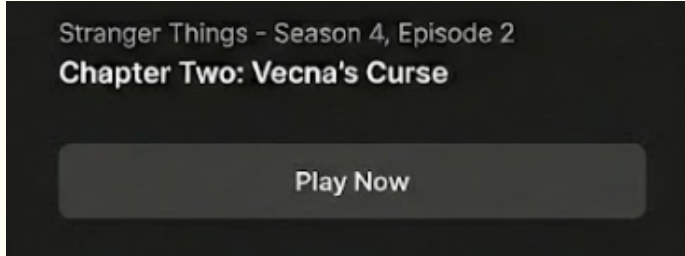
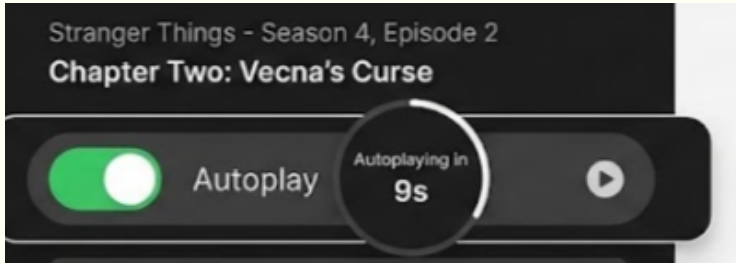
Ram logs into Streama after a tired workday on Wednesday

Hour 0



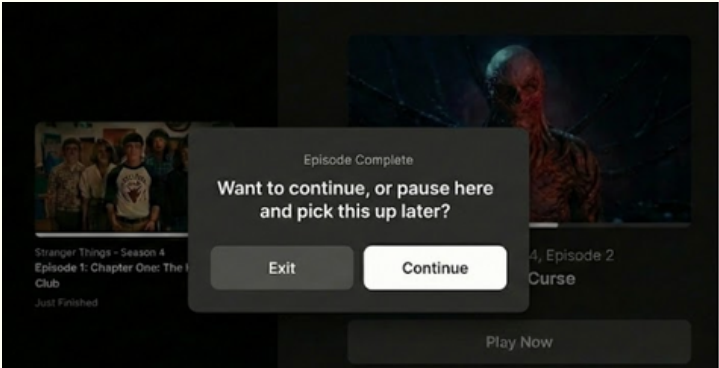
Model predicts threshold to be 2.5 hours for Ram

Hour 1



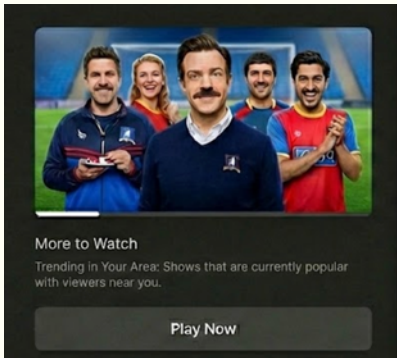
Ram starts to see Autoplay feature toggled off and he has to manually play the next episode. Button is not automatically focused. (strategic friction)

Hour 1.5



Ram sees gentle nudges after every episode to resume tomorrow

Hour 2



Ram sees recommendation of lighter genres instead of similar shows.

He ideally logs off or switches to lighter content



Execution Roadmap

Phase (months)	Objective & Risks Addressed	Actions	Reach
Model Training (0–2)	Validate prediction accuracy; mitigate false-positive intervention risk	Run session awareness engine in shadow mode with no UX changes	internal testing
Phase 1 (MVP) – P0 (2–4)	Test acceptance of subtle wellbeing UX without breaking immersion or trust	Launch adaptive autoplay and end-of-episode closure UX	10–20%
Phase 2 – P1 (4–6)	Support emotional pacing and agency while preserving intentional bingeing	Add pacing recommendations and equal-weight pause vs continue choices	30–50%
Phase 3 – Scale (6–9)	Drive widespread adoption while monitoring trust, retention, and churn risk	Make session-aware UX the default experience	70–100% + market features to new users from other streaming platforms facing pain already

Appendix

Rational for choosing ICP

- Binge-watching prevalence and intensity (young adults)
- <https://www.sciencefocus.com/science/why-binge-watching-is-bad-for-you>
- Psychological motivations and emotional coping behind binge-watching
- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC7344932/>
- Personality traits and self-regulation issues linked to binge-watching
- <https://www.mdpi.com/2071-1050/12/14/5810>
- Mental fatigue, emotional exhaustion, and post-session effects
- <https://www.mdpi.com/1660-4601/17/12/4469>

Sources of Similar Solutions

- Autoplay impact on prolonged viewing
- https://www.researchgate.net/publication/387322263_An_Experimental_Study_Of_Netflix_Use_and_the_Effects_of_Autoplay_on_Watching_Behaviors
- YouTube “Take a Break” & time-awareness nudges
- <https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/9057455>
- Apple Screen Time (non-intrusive, opt-in controls)
- <https://www.apple.com/screen-time/>

**Thank
You**



Vojaswwin A P

**PGP TBM 26'
Masters' Union**